

Northstar Analytics
Data Pipeline Runbook
Team: Data Platform Engineering

Purpose

This runbook explains how to investigate delayed or failed customer data pipelines.

Normal Schedule

Most customer pipelines run every 30 minutes. Premium accounts with near-real-time reporting enabled run every 10 minutes. Pipelines run at 12:00 AM and 4:00 AM UTC.

Common Failure Signals

Warning signs include repeated retry attempts, missing source files, schema mismatch errors, delayed API responses, or a pipeline that has not completed for more than four hours during business time should be treated as an active incident.

Investigation Steps

First, confirm the last successful run timestamp. Second, inspect the error logs for the failing stage such as extraction or transformation. Third, determine if the issue is isolated to one customer or shared across multiple accounts. Fourth, review recent deployment notes to see if a recent change could be the cause.

Escalation Path

If the issue affects one customer and there is a known retry path, the on-call data engineer can continue investigation. If the issue affects multiple customers, scheduled exports, or executive dashboards, escalate to the incident manager immediately.

Customer Communication

When a pipeline delay exceeds four hours, customer success should proactively notify affected customers with the details of the issue and the steps being taken to resolve it. If data integrity is affected, follow the data breach response plan.